Ex. No.	**:**	**03**	**Date**	**:**	**31/07/2026**
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Application Building Using the Zia Assistant in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To build a complete Zoho Creator application, Washly, by describing it in plain language to the Zia assistant, and to review and verify the forms, workflow, reports and dashboard that Zia generates.

2. Introduction

2.1 Zia Assistant

Zia is the AI assistant built into Zoho Creator. Instead of dragging every field and writing every script by hand, the developer describes the application in natural language and Zia proposes the forms, fields, relationships, workflows, reports and pages. The developer then reviews the result, accepts it and edits whatever is wrong. Zia shortens the first draft, but the developer remains responsible for checking field types, lookups and logic.

2.2 The Washly Application

Washly is a small order tracker for a laundry and dry-cleaning shop. The shop records its customers and the services it offers, takes orders with a pickup and a delivery date, tracks each order from Received to Delivered, and wants to see total orders and revenue at a glance. It is a different business from RentEase, so it shows Zia working from a fresh description.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To describe a business application to Zia in clear natural language.
- To generate forms, relationships, a workflow, reports and a dashboard with Zia.
- To review the generated application and correct any mistakes.
- To compare building with Zia against building by hand.

4. Procedure

1. Open Zoho Creator and click the Zia icon (Ask Zia / Create with Zia) on the home page or inside the Create Application screen.
2. Choose to build a new application and paste the prompt given in Section 5.
3. Click Generate and wait while Zia prepares the application outline.
4. Review the outline, which lists the forms, fields, workflow, reports and page, and accept it.
5. If Zia asks about a test environment, choose Dismiss; this is a practice application.
6. Open the application in Edit mode and check every form: field types, lookups, mandatory fields and initial values.
7. Correct anything that does not match the prompt, for example a wrong field type or a missing lookup.
8. Open the application in Access mode, add sample customers, services and orders, and check the workflow, reports and dashboard.

5. Detailed Analysis

The following prompt was given to Zia.

> Create an application named Washly for a small laundry and dry-cleaning shop to track customer orders from pickup to delivery.
>
> Create these forms:
>
> 1. Customer: Customer Name (Name), Phone (Phone), Email (Email), Address (Address).
>
> 2. Service: Service Name (Single Line), Category (Drop Down: Wash and Fold, Dry Clean, Iron Only, Shoe Care), Price Per Item (Currency, INR).
>
> 3. Laundry_Order: Order No (Auto Number), Customer (Lookup to Customer), Service (Lookup to Service), Number of Items (Number), Pickup Date (Date), Delivery Date (Date), Total Amount (Currency), Order Status (Drop Down: Received, Washing, Ready, Delivered; initial value Received), Payment Status (Radio: Paid, Unpaid; initial value Unpaid).
>
> Add a workflow so that Total Amount is calculated as Number of Items multiplied by the Price Per Item of the selected Service, and an email is sent to the customer when an order is created.
>
> Create a list report for every form, a Kanban report of Laundry_Order grouped by Order Status, and a chart report of orders by Service.
>
> Create a dashboard page showing the total number of orders, total revenue and a chart of orders by Order Status.

Prompt 1: Prompt used to generate the Washly application

Table 1 lists the forms requested from Zia.

Form	Fields requested
Customer	Customer Name (Name), Phone (Phone), Email (Email), Address (Address)
Service	Service Name (Single Line), Category (Drop Down), Price Per Item (Currency)
Laundry_Order	Order No (Auto Number), Customer (Lookup), Service (Lookup), Number of Items (Number), Pickup Date (Date), Delivery Date (Date), Total Amount (Currency), Order Status (Drop Down), Payment Status (Radio)

Table 1: Forms requested from Zia

Table 2 lists the other components requested.

Component	Requested behaviour
Workflow	Calculate Total Amount as Number of Items times the Price Per Item of the selected Service; email the customer when an order is created
List reports	One list report for each of the three forms
Kanban report	Laundry_Order cards grouped by Order Status
Chart report	Number of orders for each Service
Dashboard page	Total orders, total revenue and a chart of orders by Order Status

Table 2: Other components requested from Zia

Table 3 compares building with Zia and building by hand, as observed while building RentEase manually and Washly with Zia.

Aspect	With Zia	By hand (as in RentEase)
Time for first draft	Minutes, from one prompt	Hours, form by form
Control over settings	Needs review and correction	Full control of every property
Lookups and formulas	Must be checked after generation	Set directly while building
Best use	Quick prototypes and simple applications	Applications with detailed rules and validations

Table 3: Comparison of Zia and manual development

6. Output

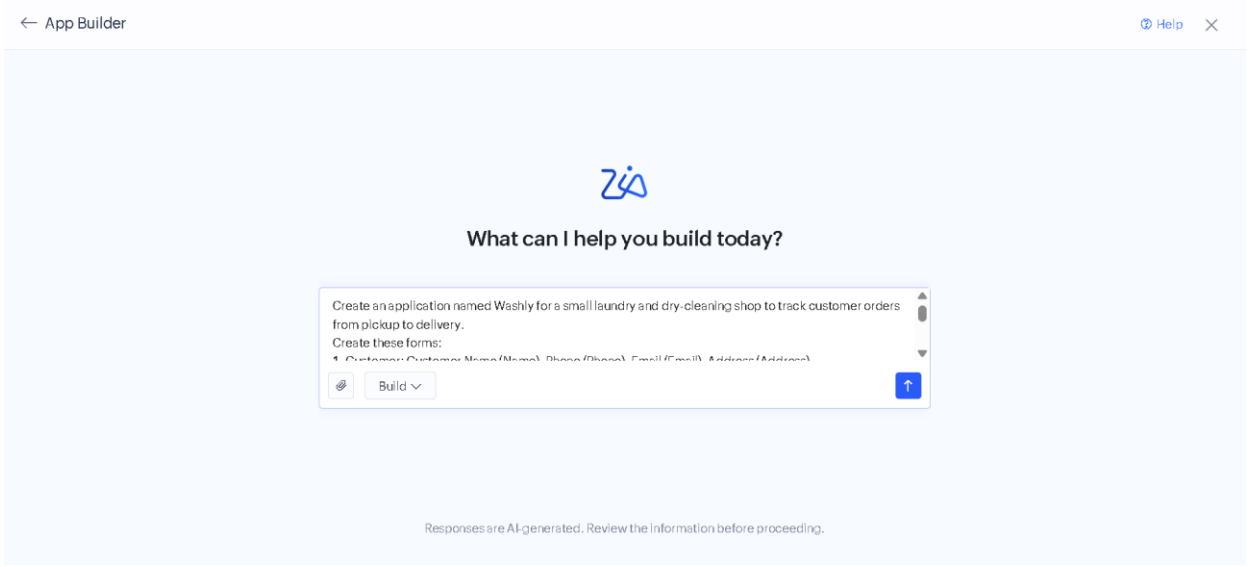


Figure 1: Prompt entered in the Zia assistant

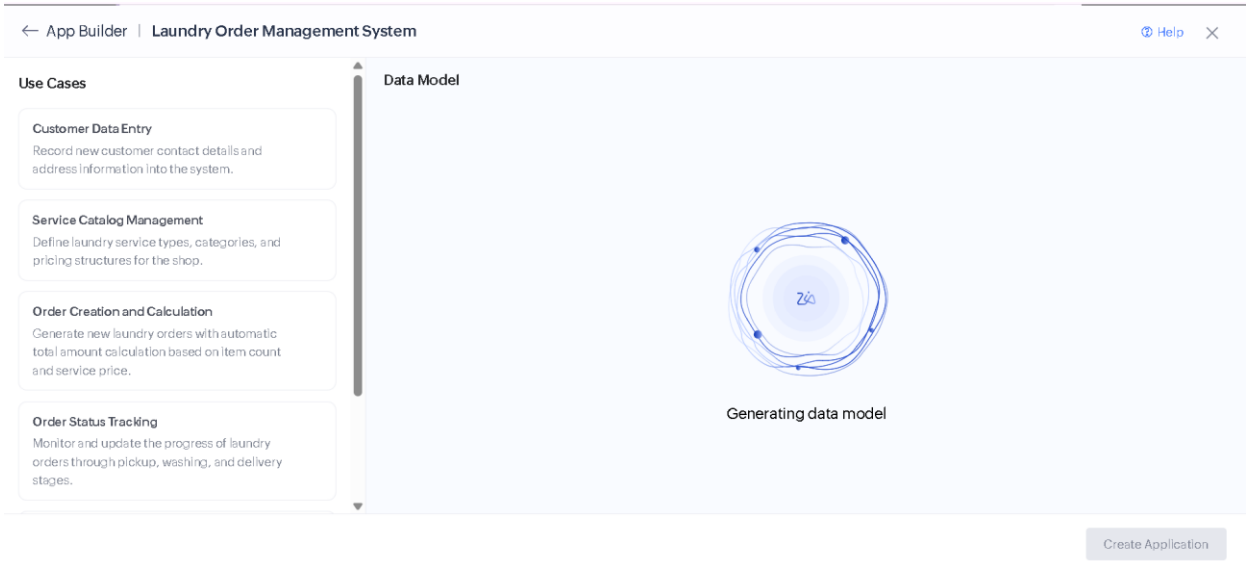


Figure 2: Application outline generated by Zia

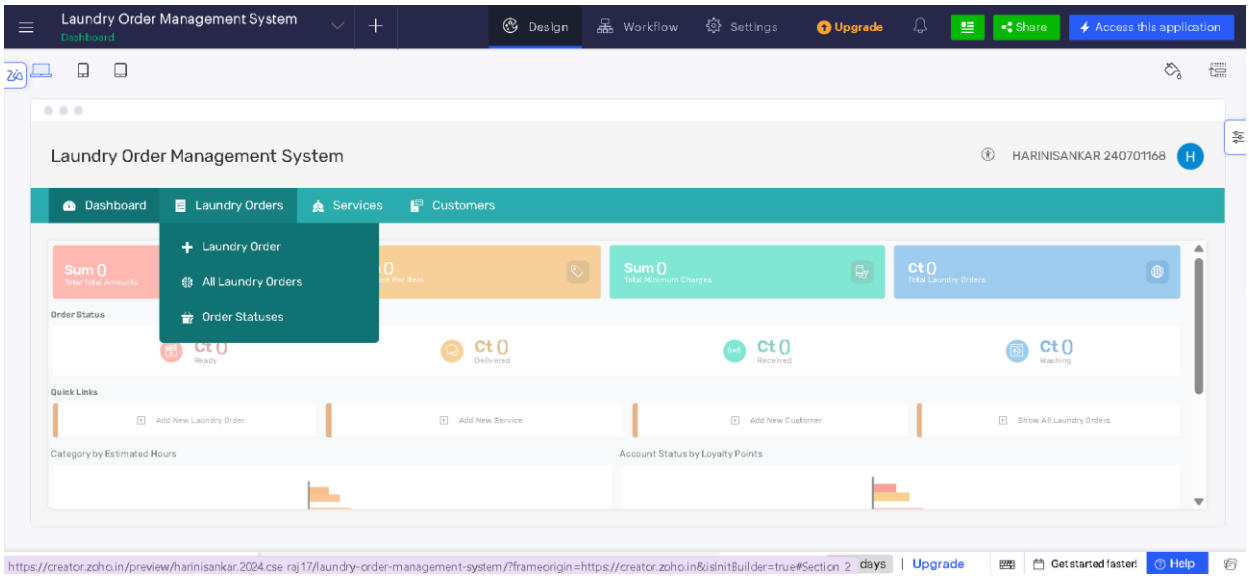


Figure 3: Forms generated by Zia

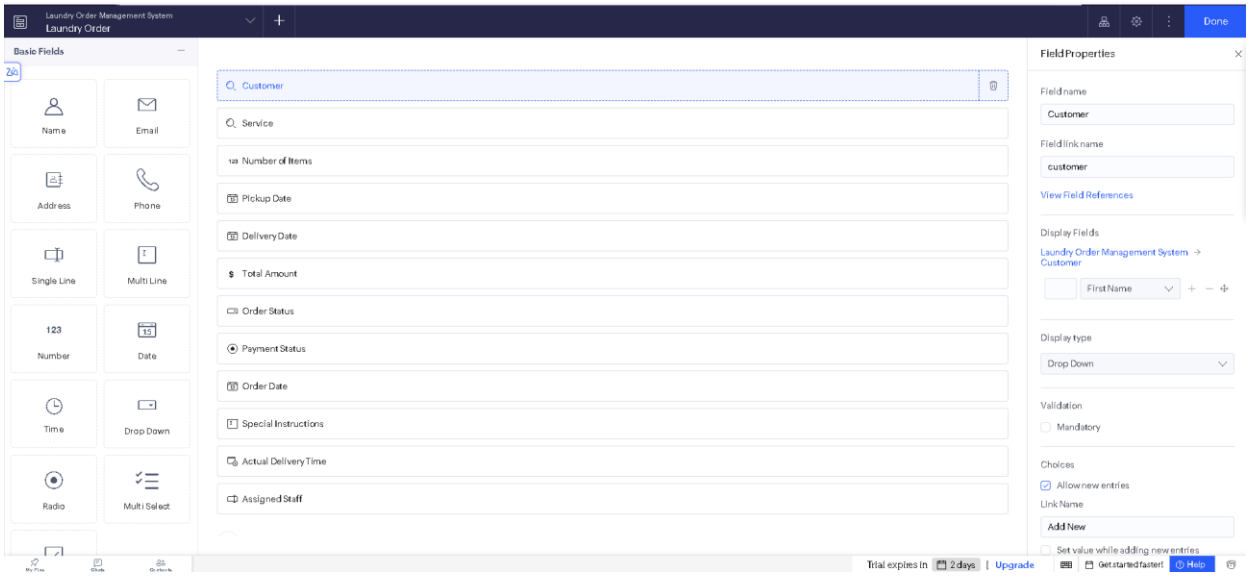


Figure 4: Laundry_Order form with lookups

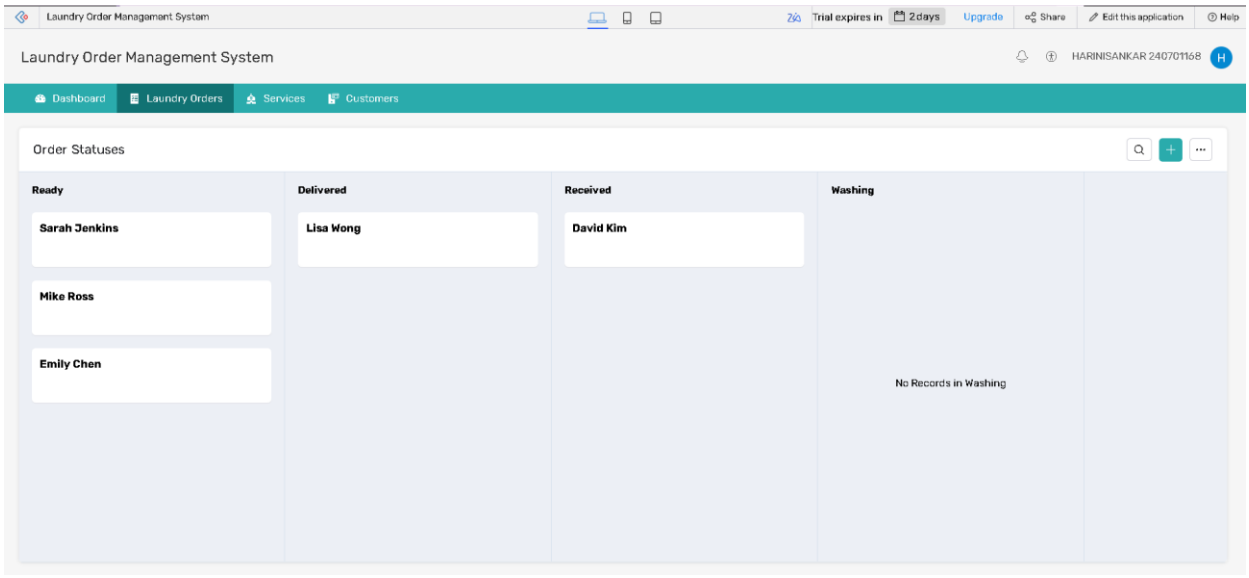


Figure 5: Order reports with sample records

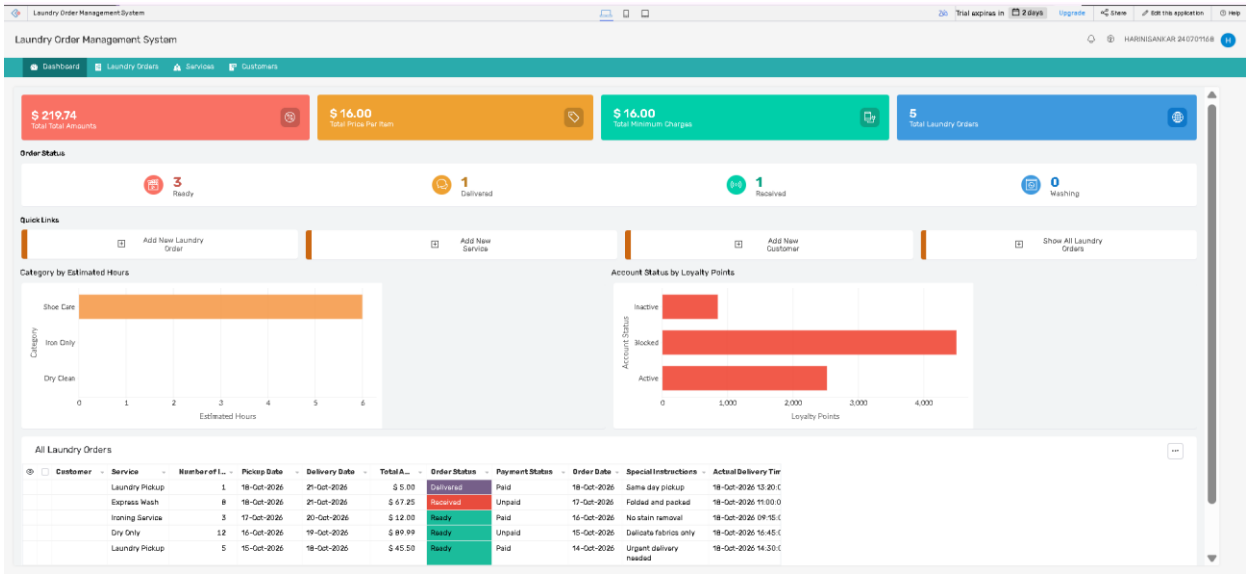


Figure 6: Washly dashboard

7. Result

The Washly application was generated in Zoho Creator from a single natural-language prompt given to the Zia assistant. The generated forms, workflow, reports and dashboard were reviewed, corrected where needed and tested with sample orders. The experiment shows that Zia can produce a working first draft of a business application in minutes, while the developer still has to verify field types, relationships and calculations.